

Emmanuel Karanja

Software Engineer | UI/UX Designer

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SUMMARY

Full Stack Engineer & UI/UX Designer with 5+ years building scalable web platforms across SaaS, fintech, and Ed-Tech. Proven ability to own products end-to-end, from Figma prototype to production, shipping for platforms with 250k+ users. Experienced working remotely with US startups on aggressive timelines.

EDUCATION

Bsc. Science in Applied Computing

[KCA University](#)

May 2019 - April 2023

EXPERIENCE

Founder & CTO
[Elimu Bora Solutions Ltd](#)

Oct 2025 - Present
Nairobi, Kenya - Remote

- Founded Elimu Bora Solutions Ltd and lead Elimu Bora ERP, a school management platform built for Kenyan schools, owning product, design, engineering, and go to market end to end.
- Architected and built the core platform on Laravel, Filament, Vue.js, and Inertia.js, with a PostgreSQL backend using row level security for multi tenancy, deployed on DigitalOcean via Laravel Forge.
- Onboarded the company's first paying school client, with three more schools currently in the sales pipeline.
- Designed and shipped core school workflows including CBC & 8-4-4 grading, M-Pesa fee collection, attendance tracking, and a parent portal.
- Led marketing and sales efforts (Google Business Profile, Google Ads, social content), including a marketing site deployed on Cloudflare Workers, to position the product against established players like Zeraki and Intellimis.

Stack: PHP, Laravel, Filament, Vue.js, Alpine.js, Inertia.js, PostgreSQL, DigitalOcean, Cloudflare Workers, Tailwind CSS

Full Stack Web Developer & UI/UX Designer

Jul 2023 - Jan 2026

Blue Book Publications, Inc.

Alabama, USA - Remote

- Drove end-to-end development for Blue Book Publications, Inc. digital suite, serving 250k+ registered users and 55k weekly actives.
- Sole UI/UX designer and lead developer: designed and oversaw implementation of a new marketplace, transforming the platform's engagement.
- Engineered a new search experience using Algolia, dramatically improving user discoverability and satisfaction.
- Led major UI/UX overhauls using Figma, directly resulting in a 30% increase in conversion and engagement.
- Recognized by management for design quality, product vision, and the ability to deliver across both design and technical roles.

Full Stack Web Developer & UI/UX Designer

Feb 2023 - Jun 2023

Chanl AI

New York, USA - Remote

- Collaborated directly with founders to shape product direction and deliver on aggressive timelines.
- Designed, prototyped, and iterated on core user experiences in Figma, ensuring seamless client onboarding and product usability.
- Owned and implemented most frontend features with Vue.js; contributed to backend using NestJS.
- Contributed to onboarding and retaining the company's first three paying clients through rapid product iterations and customer-centric design.

Stack: PHP, Laravel, Javascript, VueJS, MySQL, TailwindCSS, Adobe XD, Figma

Full Stack Web Developer & UI/UX Designer

May 2021 - Feb 2023

SYNTAX LTD

Nairobi, Kenya - On site

- Responsible for frontend development and UI/UX design across multiple high-traffic projects, including a finance app with 20,000+ users, a real estate portal, and a NFT platform.
- Designed and shipped complete user interfaces for a chess mobile game app and a delivery web app, ensuring consistent, easy to use & modern user experiences.
- Collaborated closely with project stakeholders to iterate rapidly on prototypes using Figma and Adobe XD.
- Contributed to backend development using Laravel, supporting scalable, robust web platforms.
- Drove SEO improvements and participated in server management to maintain high site reliability and performance.

Stack: PHP, Laravel, Javascript, VueJS, MySQL, TailwindCSS, Adobe XD, Figma

IT Intern

Feb 2020 - May 2020

The Dream Factory Kenya

Nairobi, Kenya - On site

- Supported a cross-functional team in designing and maintaining efficient databases using MySQL and PHP.
- Assisted with UI prototyping and frontend development using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Contributed to SEO initiatives to drive more traffic to client websites.

Stack: PHP, Laravel, Javascript, VueJS, TailwindCSS, MySQL

SKILLS

Programming Languages & Frameworks

PHP, Laravel, TypeScript, Vue.js, Livewire, Filament, Inertia.js, Tailwind CSS, Node.js, NestJS.

Database

MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, GraphQL, Redis, Algolia.

Cloud & DevOps

AWS, Docker, CI/CD pipelines, Nginx, Apache.

Design

Figma, Adobe XD, Photoshop, Illustrator, After Effects.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.